ACTIVITY – TRUE OR FALSE

Which of the following statements is true about today's world?

a) Monarchy as a form of government has vanished. **Ans :** _____

b) The relationship between different countries has become more democratic than ever before.
Ans : _____

c) In more and more countries, rulers are being elected by the people.
Ans: _____

d) There are no more military dictators in the world.
Ans : _____

e) Which is the good form of government Democracy or Polity?

f) Democracy is a failure in a country of people who are ignorant.

g) Democracy fails when the rights of the people are taken away

Scholars view of Democracy



Democracy is a 'living reality' in every sphere of social, economic and political activity.

- George Douglas Howard Cole



Democracy is defined as,

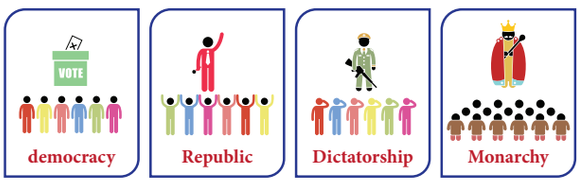
1. A government by the people; especially: rule of the majority:
2. A government in which the supreme power is vested in the people and exercised by them directly or indirectly through a system of representation usually involving periodically held free elections.

- Thomas Jefferson

5.2 Theories of Democracy

Democracy is a theory that has various applications in different historical periods, different civilizations and cultures. The Ancient theory of Democracy emerged in Ancient Greece that saw the rise of several city-states (polis) which believed and applied the procedure of Direct election, Debating of public policies and Decision by the people. Greek Civilization, Culture and Language spread widely throughout Europe in the ancient historical period. And it also saw the spread of democracy as a "form" and "system" of government initially in Europe and later into North and South America.

As the Greek polis increased in size the nation of democracy by elected representatives gained importance and relevance. Representative democracy later emerged as the dominant form and system of government in the European Middle Ages, the Age of Enlightenment. The mass popular demand for Democracy was made in the American (1775-1783) and French Revolutions (1789-1799). Democracy has now emerged as a "universal" form of government widely accepted by several countries with various people groups, cultures and languages.



There are various Theories of Democracy defined in terms of scope and impact:

5.2.1 Classical Democracy: Emerged as a direct form of democracy in Ancient Greece. Athens was the first city to

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